

MANTIS

SHE WAS ONLY A SIMPLE BAR GIRL, but she was destined to change the universe! Her father was a mercenary named Gustav Brandt and her mother was the sister of a criminal who disapproved of the marriage. Shortly after Mantis was born, her father was blinded in a fire and her mother was killed. The infant was raised by monks who taught her martial arts. She also developed the ability to sense the emotions of others.

THE CELESTIAL MADONNA

After leaving the monastery, Mantis became a barmaid to support herself and met the Swordsman who was still working for criminals. She convinced him to reform, and they journeyed to the U.S. and began helping the Avengers. The Swordsman gave his life to save Mantis from Kang when the tyrant learned that Mantis was destined to become the Celestial Madonna and that her son would bring a new golden age of peace to the universe.



LIBRA

Blinded in the fire that killed his wife, Gustav Brandt carried his child to a monastery. After the priests taught him to "see" by psychic means, he took the name Libra and joined the Zodiac, an international crime cartel.

Sentient Plants

One of the Cotati, an alien race of sentient plants, reanimated Swordsman and he married Mantis. They abandoned their physical bodies and their spirits went on a long journey through space. After conceiving a child, Mantis returned to Earth and created a new body for herself out of plant matter. She raised her son in Connecticut until it was time for him to begin his work and return to space.

Mantis and the Swordsman came to realize they were *unequals*.



POWER PLANT

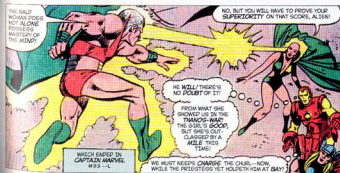
Possessing the same physical powers in her plant-like body Mantis has aided the Silver Surfer and the West Coast Avengers.

MOONDAGON

HEAATHER DOUGLAS was only three years old when her parents were murdered by an alien menace named Thanos. She was taken to Titan, a moon of Saturn, and raised by a race of genetically-enhanced Eternals. She became a martial-arts master and found that she could control the minds of others.

GODDESS GONE WILD

Believing that she had become a goddess and was destined to be the Celestial Madonna, Moondragon helped the Avengers defeat Thanos. She then joined the team, but her arrogance got on everyone's nerves. She later mentally enslaved the Avengers and used them to conquer a small planet. After overthrowing her, Thor turned Moondragon over to Odin for punishment.

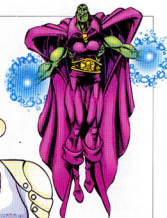


MIND POWERS

Moondragon can erect psionic shields, fire mental blasts, and fly. She can brainwash a person into doing her will.

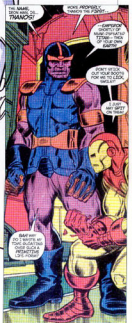
Cheating Death

Moondragon learned that she was dying and made a deal with an alien monster to save herself. The monster destroyed her but, before she died, Moondragon projected her mind, first into the body of her cousin and then into a clone of her original body. The new Moondragon briefly rejoined the Avengers, and then became a member of Infinity Watch, a group of heroes with cosmic powers.



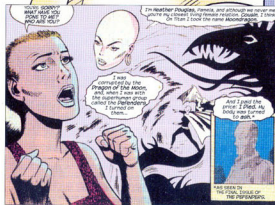
DRAX

Moondragon's father was Arthur Douglas, a real-estate agent. After his body was destroyed, his mind was transferred into a powerful android body and sent to destroy Thanos.



THANOS

Born on Titan, Thanos was superhumanly strong and obsessed with death and power. He dedicated himself to eliminating all life in the universe.



KEEPING UP THE PRESSURE

A master of the martial arts, Mantis knew exactly where to strike and could even stun someone as powerful as the mighty Thor. She also studied meditation and had total control over her body. Not only could she ignore great pain, but she could also heal quickly.